

1 GB

Scoreboard	Corsair Voyager 1 GB	Moser Baer 1 GB	Toshiba 1 GB	Transcend JetFlash V30 1 GB	Transcend JetFlash 168
BRAND MODEL					
Price (Exclusive Of Taxes)	550	480	470	550	700
Comments	+ Rugged - Slow performer	+ Fast, looks good - None in particular	+ Attractive Looker - Mediocre performer	+ Attractive - Very Slow	+ Attractive, reasonably fast - None in particular
Grand Totals (Out Of 100)	40.00	42.75	37.66	29.21	41.28
Features	20.86	13.09	13.44	15.26	14.77
Performance	19.14	29.66	24.22	13.95	26.51
Features					
Storage Capacity (Claimed)	1 GB	1 GB	1 GB	1 GB	1 GB
Storage Capacity (Actual)	967 MB	960 MB	960 MB	969 MB	998 MB
Security	NA	N	N	N	N
Software Features	6	0	0	0	5
Visual Indicators (LED, etc.)	Y	N	N	Y	N
Other Accessories Provided	USB Extension cable	NA	NA	lanyard cable	lanyard cable
Other Features		NA	NA	NA	NA
Build Quality (Scale Of 10)					
Quality Of Materials Used	7.5	6.5	6.5	5.5	6
Sturdiness Of The Overall Package	7.75	6.5	6.5	5.5	6.5
Cap Locking Mechanism	7	7	7.5	7	6
Performance					
HD-Tach 3 (8 MB Write Tests)					
Random Access Time	0.9 ms	0.5 ms	0.4 ms	0.6 ms	8.7 ms
Average Read Speed	16.7 MBps	28.5	18.7	18.2	12.4
Average Write Speed	7.35 MBps	4.6	7.5	6.8	8.6
Read Burst Speed	17 MBps	23.6	18.8	19.2	14.4
CPU Utilisation (%)	0	0.04	0.05	0.03	0
SiSoft Sandra 2007 (64MB File Test)					
Read	16.38 MBps	18.53	17.47	18.23	14.19
Write	4.36 MBps	4.63	7.46	4.53	6.47
File Transfer Test					
Write-100 MB (Sequential)	4.19 MBps	7.57	7.88	5.75	8.23
Read-100 MB (Sequential)	16.19 MBps	26.74	20.41	10.83	13.62
Write-100 MB (Assorted)	0.78 MBps	1.08	0.93	0.29	4.11
Read-100 MB (Assorted)	13.71 MBps	13.19	14.95	8.89	14.58
Write-1 GB (Sequential)	4.15 MBps	6.23	7.85	1.44	8.40
Read-1 GB (Sequential)	14.93 MBps	33.68	13.24	5.00	12.73
Write-1 GB (Assorted Files)	2.71 MBps	6.21	4.07	1.25	5.25
Read-1 GB (Assorted Files)	11.84 MBps	28.04	16.18	3.73	13.74

Trancend's JetFlash V10 4 GB. An excellent product—it's fast, reasonably rugged and a steal at just Rs 1,600. The only other worthy alternative is the Corsair Voyager 4 GB (Rs 1,550). It's the third-fastest drive in the comparison and has a decent bundle (similar to the other Voyager drives).

Once again, Toshiba's much acclaimed TransMemory drives failed to impress. We were surprised at the lacklustre performance of the Buffalo 4 GB drive and even with Turbo USB enabled we didn't notice a big improvement. In fact this was the case in the 2GB category as well, sure a difference of 2-3 percent with Turbo USB enabled may seem significant, but its not a big deal and not really noticeable in reality—more over its a far cry from the claimed 16 percent performance hike.

2 GB

Buffalo Turbo USB 2GB	Corsair Voyager 2 GB	Kingston DataTraveler	Kingston DataTraveler Reader 2GB	Moser Baer 2 GB	SanDisk Cruzer Titanium U3 2GB
					
970	900	2850	2500	735	1590
+ Looks good - Turbo mode not effective	+ Rugged and Fast - None in particular	+ Well built - Very slow	+ Feature Rich - Slow	+ Fast performer - Flimsy design	+ Extremely Well Built - Heavy
37.30	51.77	27.72	33.16	41.65	50.56
13.09	20.86	12.25	13.65	13.09	24.71
24.21	30.91	15.47	19.51	28.56	25.85
2 GB	2 GB	2 GB	2 GB	2 GB	2 GB
1.88 GB	1.88 GB	1.86 GB	1.95 GB	1.88 GB	1.9 GB
N	N	NA	NA	N	Y
0	6	0	0	0	8
N	Y	N	N	N	Y
NA	USB Extension cable	NA	NA	NA	NA
NA		NA	Card Reader	NA	NA
6.5	7.5	6	6	6.5	8
6.5	7.75	6.25	6.5	6.5	7.5
7	7	6.5	6.5	7	6.5
0.6 ms	0.9 ms	1 ms	0.7 ms	0.5 ms	0.4 ms
21.2	29.6	12.8	12.6	30.4	20.6
6.1	11.2	6.5	7.6	4.5	8.4
22.3	31	13.7	12.9	25	21
0.06	0	0	0.04	0.03	0.09
21.36	29.49	11.12	13.84	18.56	19.12
4.61	6.55	5.73	6.84	4.36	7.33
4.28	7.76	4.29	6.46	4.02	7.26
47.17	31.15	10.09	12.79	19.19	19.61
0.74	1.11	0.30	0.61	0.62	1.50
13.23	12.99	7.45	11.68	10.66	8.75
4.24	7.51	5.90	6.18	7.05	7.60
19.61	27.68	13.78	12.43	37.48	18.57
3.30	4.03	2.08	4.19	6.34	6.30
17.50	21.49	9.29	11.58	30.36	16.61

Flash Forward

We've seen flash emerging from a niche product to something that is properly mainstream. But as of now this applies to thumb drives only. On the bigger scene flash memory has pervaded more than just your pocket. It has seen usage as a storage medium, particularly in notebooks, where power consumption is a necessary evil. The fact that flash has no moving parts and consumes a fraction of the power of its magnetic siblings, is an attractive enough reason for vendors to use it, despite the fact that anything more than 16 GB of flash is very expensive.

As the drive for convergence leads to better PDAs, multimedia phones, PMPs and their ilk, with more features and customisability, the demand for storage as a medium will increase by leaps and bounds. Flash has been waiting in the wings for a while now—a nascent period that saw a growth of no more than 10 per cent.

We're still going to prefer 500 GB hard drives for awhile, and it'll take some time for extremely high density flash modules to enter the consumer space. However, when it comes to portable storage, the invasion of *flash* has already begun...

OBESE INDULGENCES—8 GB
Features

With the ability to store 8 gigabytes of data, you can actually extract entire DVDs to such drives. Kingston's DataTraveler Secure was a hulk of a drive—heavy, and claimed to be waterproof (up to four feet under-water); something we didn't test. Buffalo's Turbo USB was identical to the other Buffalo drives, and that's a good thing. The 8 GB Cruzer from SanDisk was built identically to the other Cruzer drives—exemplary. The other attractive looking drive was the Transcend JetFlash V30 which used a shiny black, translucent body to convey all the appeal it needed to. It's rather compact too, and was the smallest of the 8 GB drives.



Transcend V60 8 GB
One stop data shop!